



NEURODIVERSITY WORKSHOP

Presenter Felix Ndebele



What is Neurodiversity?

- Neurodiversity is not mental health
- However, children with neurodevelopmental difficulties are highly likely to suffer with mental health difficulties, compared to neurotypical children

Questions?





Reasons for high prevalence of mental health in Neurodiverse population.

- Exclusion
- Unmet needs, relationships, academical achievements, employment
- Likely to have complex needs as neurodevelopmental presentations tend to co-occur



What is Neurodiversity?

- Neurodiversity' refers to the natural diversity in human brains.
- Neurodivergence is the term for when someone's brain processes, learns, and/or behaves differently from what is considered "typical". Some neurodivergent conditions include:
 - <https://www.rcn.org.uk/Get-Help/Member-support-services/Peer-support-services/Neurodiversity-Guidance/What-is-Neurodiversity>

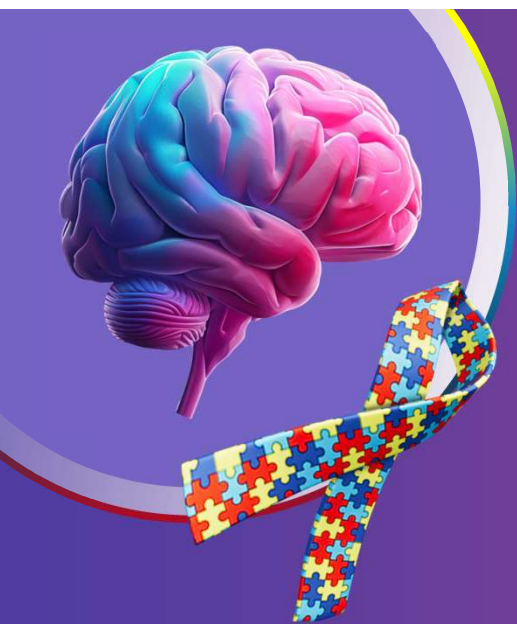


Neurodiversity is not mental illness

- It cannot be treated
- It is a lifelong condition that people need to learn to live with
- The neurodivergent people need to be accepted and accommodated
- This discussion will place more emphasis on understanding and adapting the environment in order to help individuals



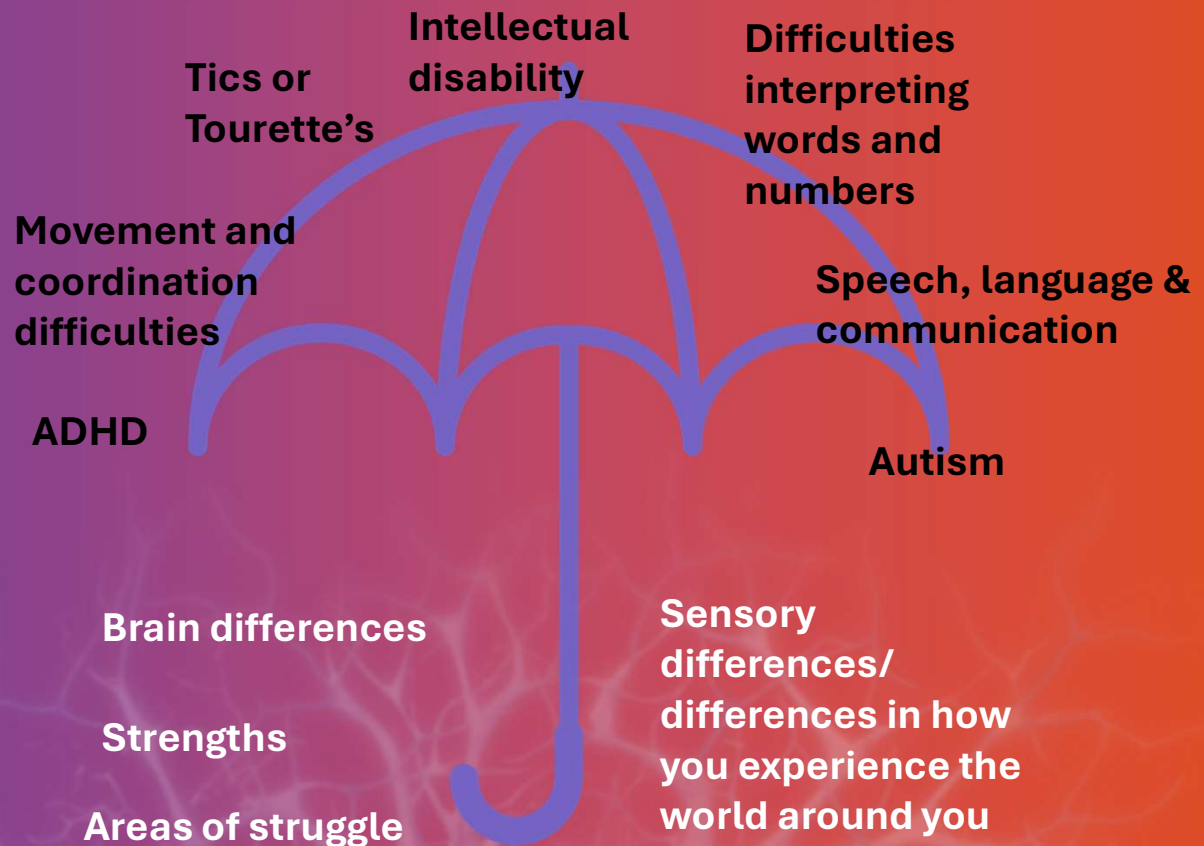
- Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD)
- Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD):
- Intellectual Disability (ID):
- Specific Learning Disorders
- Communication Deficits:
- Motor Disorders:
- Other Neurodevelopmental Disorders:



Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD)

ASD is characterized by difficulties in social interaction, communication, and repetitive behaviors. It's a spectrum disorder, meaning symptoms can vary widely among individuals.

Sub-groups of neurodivergence





Attention-Deficit/Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD):

ADHD is characterized by inattention, hyperactivity, and impulsivity. It can interfere with functioning and development in multiple areas, such as school, work, and relationships.



Intellectual Disability (ID)

ID involves limitations in intellectual functioning and adaptive behaviors. It typically manifests before age 18 and can vary in severity.



Specific Learning Disorders

These disorders affect the acquisition and use of specific academic skills, such as reading, writing, or math, despite adequate intelligence and educational opportunities.



Communication Disorders:

These disorders affect the ability to understand, use, or produce language. They include conditions like speech sound disorder, language disorder, and stuttering.



Motor Disorders:

These disorders affect movement and coordination. Examples include Developmental Coordination Disorder (DCD) and Tic Disorders like Tourette Syndrome.



Other Neurodevelopmental Disorders:

This category includes conditions like Rett Syndrome, Childhood Disintegrative Disorder, and Stereotypic Movement Disorder.



Diagnosis of neurodiversity difficulties

- Every child is different but the early warning signs centre around delays in hitting the developmental milestones
- It is also important to note that girls develop quicker than boys

Early signs of neurodevelopmental difficulties

- A** • **Social Interaction Challenges:** Difficulty in understanding social cues, avoiding eye contact, or showing no interest in playing with others

Delayed Speech:

- B** Not developing speech in a typical manner, or having difficulty following nonverbal communication.

- C** **Narrow Interests:** Showing intense interests in specific topics or activities, often ignoring other activities

- C** **Repetitive Behaviours:** Engaging in repetitive movements or behaviours, such as hand flapping or body rocking



Neurodevelopmental Disorder

Causes, Complications, & Consequences



**Specialized
Treatment**

COGNITIVE

Complications of cognitive neurodevelopmental disorders may include academic struggles, social difficulties, and challenges in daily functioning.

MOTOR

Complications of motor neurodevelopmental disorders may involve difficulties with coordination, movement, and physical activities.

SEIZURES

Complications of seizures neurodevelopmental disorders include physical injury, cognitive impairments, and social stigma.

BEHAVIOR

Complications of behavior neurodevelopmental disorders may include academic underachievement, strained relationships, and challenges in daily life.

Prefrontal Cortex Function:

A

The prefrontal cortex, situated in the frontal lobe, governs higher-order cognitive functions such as decision-making, planning, problem-solving, and impulse control.

Temporal Lobe Function:

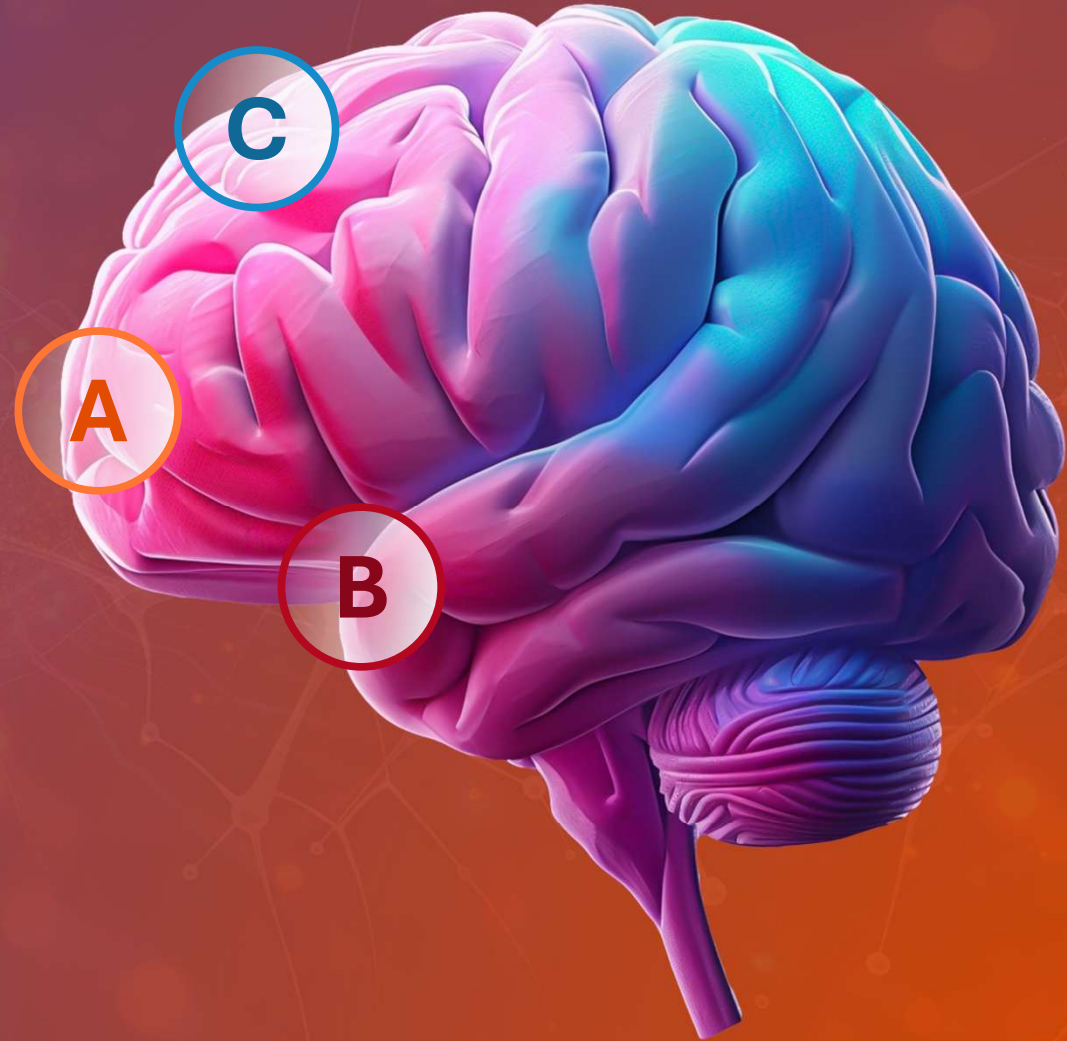
B

The temporal lobe, located on the sides of the brain, hosts key functions such as auditory processing, memory formation, and language comprehension.

Frontal Lobe Function:

C

The frontal lobe, positioned at the front of the brain, orchestrates diverse cognitive functions, including decision-making, problem-solving, voluntary movement, and emotional regulation.



Strategies for Neurodevelopmental Disorders

Behavioral Therapy:

Various behavioral interventions, such as Applied Behavior Analysis (ABA) or Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT), can help individuals learn new skills, manage symptoms, and improve their functioning.

Speech and Language Therapy:

Speech-language pathologists can assist individuals in improving communication skills, including speech articulation, language comprehension, and social communication.



Medication Management:

Pharmacological treatments may be prescribed to alleviate specific symptoms associated with neurodevelopmental disorders.

Occupational Therapy:

Occupational therapists focus on developing fine motor skills, sensory processing abilities, and activities of daily living to enhance independence and functioning in individuals with neurodevelopmental disorders.

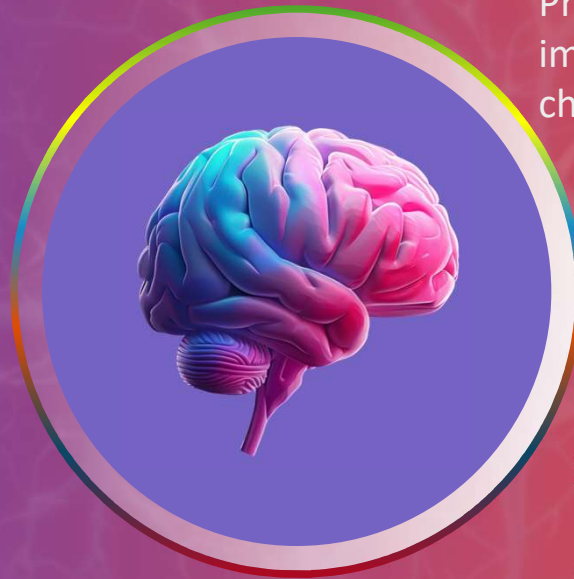
Strategies for Neurodevelopmental Disorders

Early intervention:

Early identification and intervention can lead to better outcomes and support for children with neurodevelopmental disorders.

Positive affirmations:

Try and build on the child's strengths instead of focusing on what they can't do (deficit model).



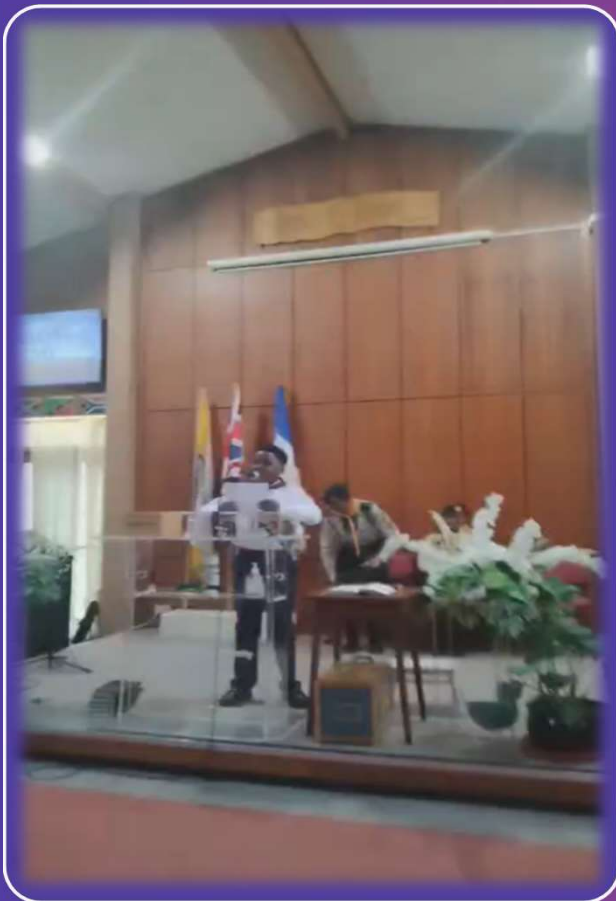
Parent Education and Support:

Provide guidance and resources to parents for implementing strategies at home and managing challenges.

Social skills training:

Offer opportunities for learning and practicing social skills in structured settings.

Strengths based approach



Insects



musicality

Smart studying skills

Autism Spectrum Disorder (ASD)



- Active Recall
- Spaced Repetition
- Pomodoro Technique
- Self-Testing
- See handout

Specialized Talents/Strengths



Play on Wandi



TikTok

@sekawandisekawandi



Specialized Talents/Strengths



Baptism



Questions?



Thankyou

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